

REQUIREMENTS & SCOPING

This document is to support the development team in building the AI self-service assistant for store IT support. It defines the business need, scope, and requirements for the solution. It is to be completed by the Business Analyst and signed off by the stakeholders listed before design and development begin.

First Review / Prioritisation / Requirements gathering meeting.

Project Name: Reducing IT Service Desk Ticket Volume Through AI-Powered Self-Service Support

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1. Project overview

1.1 Project description

The IT Service Desk receives around 450 to 600 calls per week from retail stores. Analysis of one year of TOPdesk data found that 68.8% of these calls are deflectable, meaning a documented fix already existed, the issue was resolved on the first call, and no supplier was required. A documented fix was available for 86% of all calls, yet stores still contacted the desk, showing the problem is access to knowledge rather than its absence.

This project delivers an AI self-service assistant that allows store staff to resolve common IT issues themselves, in their own words, at the point of need.

Stakeholder(s) included in initial discussion:	Role in this project	Does the stakeholder approve this document? (Y/N)
Head of Retail IT	Decision maker and budget holder. Approves the solution and its business case.	Y
IT Service Desk Manager	Project sponsor. Owns the call volume problem and the target benefits.	Y
Store Managers	Primary end user. Raises access and trading-critical issues.	Y
Store Users (employees)	Primary end user. Raises day to day device and till faults.	Y
Service Desk Analysts	Internal end user and SME. Currently resolves the calls being deflected.	Y

2. User Stories

Store Manager	Store User	Service Desk Analyst
1.1 As a store manager, I want to reset my own password through the AI assistant so that I do not have to wait in a call queue. <i>Acceptance: identity is verified before any reset. The assistant guides the reset for intranet, Edge, or Oracle. Access is regained without an analyst.</i>	2.1 As a store user, I want to describe my problem in my own words so that I do not need to know the correct technical term. <i>Acceptance: the assistant correctly interprets vague or misspelled input such as HHT not woking and maps it to the right issue and fix.</i>	3.1 As a service desk analyst, I want the assistant to resolve documented first-line issues without my involvement so that I can focus on complex work. <i>Acceptance: issues with a documented fix are deflected at source. First-line call volume for these categories reduces measurably.</i>
1.2 As a store manager, I want guided help for a till or card machine fault so that I can restore trading quickly. <i>Acceptance: the assistant provides the documented reboot and reconnect steps. If the till stays down, it escalates with the details already captured.</i>	2.2 As a store user, I want step by step help for a scanner, POS, or printer fault so that I can keep serving customers. <i>Acceptance: the assistant walks through the documented fix. Unresolved cases escalate automatically without the user repeating themselves.</i>	3.2 As a service desk analyst, I want every assistant interaction logged in TOPdesk so that we keep full visibility of store demand. <i>Acceptance: every interaction, resolved or escalated, creates a TOPdesk record with category, description, and outcome.</i>

3. Objectives and Business Impact

Objective	Business Impact	KPIs	Users
Enable self-service resolution of access issues	Removes the single largest call driver. Access is the highest volume category in the analysis	% of access calls deflected	Store Manager, Store User
Enable guided self-fix of till and device faults	Faster recovery of trading-critical equipment without waiting in a queue	Average time to restore a till or device	Store Manager, Store User
Interpret imprecise, everyday language	Makes self-service usable by non-technical staff. 41% of call descriptions are three words or fewer.	Intent recognition rate, % resolved without escalation	Store User

Reduce repetitive first-line workload	Around 1.9 full-time analysts freed for complex work, worth approximately £99,000 a year	Analyst hours spent on first-line store calls	Service Desk Analyst
Maintain full visibility of store demand	Deflected issues stay measurable, so reporting and trend analysis are not lost	% of assistant interactions logged in TOPdesk	Service Desk Analyst, Service Desk Manager

4. Scope of the project

4.1 In scope

The top deflectable categories identified in the data analysis:

- Password and access issues (intranet, Edge, Oracle, account lockouts)
- POS and till issues, including card machines
- Printer faults (receipt, label, Brother)
- Scanner faults
- Handheld device (HHT) issues

Delivery is phased, starting with password and access as the highest volume and simplest win, then extending to the remaining categories.

4.2 Out of scope

- Physical hardware failures requiring a replacement or an engineer visit
- Supplier managed faults that require a third party to attend
- Any issue with no documented fix available
- Non-store users and head office support

These continue through the existing call process.

4.3 Assumptions

- Existing documented fixes are sufficient to launch. No new knowledge content is required initially.
- An adoption rate of around 65% is achievable, giving projected deflection of approximately 45% of all calls.
- Store devices and network connectivity allow access to the assistant during trading hours.

4.4 Constraints

- First-line effort is inconsistently recorded in TOPdesk today, with many calls logging zero time. The current cost baseline is therefore likely understated.
- 41% of call descriptions are three words or fewer, which sets a high bar for language interpretation.
- The assistant can only resolve issues for which a documented fix already exists.

5. Non-functional requirements

5.1 Performance

- Available 24/7, covering all store trading hours including weekends and peak trading periods.
- Responds within a few seconds per message.
- Supports concurrent use across the store estate, including the December trading peak identified in the analysis.

5.2 Security

- Verifies user identity before any account or password action.
- No sensitive action is performed without successful authentication.
- Conversation records are stored and retained in line with data protection policy.

5.3 Usability and compliance

- Usable by non-technical store staff with no training.
- Understands imprecise, misspelled, and abbreviated language.

- Always offers a clear route to a human. The user is never left without an option.
- Accessible on the devices store staff already use during trading.

6. Process flow and interface

6.1 Process flow

- **As-is process map** shows the current flow: the store logs a call in TOPdesk, it queues, an analyst picks it up, and the analyst guides the fix by phone or escalates to a third party.
- **To-be process map** shows the proposed flow: the store raises the issue with the assistant, which resolves it directly, or escalates to the existing call process where it cannot.

6.2 Interface

The assistant is conversational rather than form based, so the interface is defined by the conversation flow rather than screen layouts. A worked example covering a password reset, including the authentication step and the escalation path, accompanies this document.

7. Risks and dependencies

7.1 Risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Low adoption. Staff default to calling out of habit.	Deflection falls below the 45% target and the projected £99,000 saving is not realised	Phased rollout, clear store communications, weekly usage monitoring
The assistant misinterprets a query and gives the wrong fix.	Store trust lost, issue worsens	Confidence threshold before offering a fix, easy escalation, ongoing tuning

Weak identity checks create a security exposure.	Unauthorised account access	Mandatory authentication before any account or password action
Deflection reduces visibility of underlying faults.	Recurring problems go unnoticed and root causes are not addressed	Every assistant interaction logged to TOPdesk (user story 3.2)

7.2 Dependencies

- Integration with TOPdesk for ticket logging and reporting.
- Integration with the identity and authentication system.
- Access to current knowledge base content and its ongoing maintenance.
- Stakeholder sign-off on phasing and success measures.

Approval from the stakeholders above is required before design and development begin. Requirements in this document are derived from data analysis and service desk domain knowledge, and are to be validated with store users and analysts during review.